

Yasra Chandio

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Department of Electrical and Computer Engineering

University of Massachusetts Amherst

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Education

PhD in Computer Engineering, University of Massachusetts Amherst. 2020–2025

MS in Computer Science, Binghamton University (SUNY). 2018–2019

BS in Software Engineering, Mehran University of Engineering and Technology, Pakistan [Bronze] 2010–2014

Awards Highlights

ML and Systems Rising Star | [Link](#) 2025

IEEE VR Honorable Mention For Best Paper | Top 3% Papers 2025

MIT EECS Rising Star | 19% acceptance rate | [Link](#) 2024

– Highly selective workshop based on academic excellence and commitment to advancing DEI.

Cyber-Physical Systems (CPS) Rising Star | 16% acceptance rate | [Link](#) 2024

– Highly selective workshop based on outstanding achievements and future potential in CPS.

UMASS College of Engineering Diversity, Equity, and Inclusion (DEI) Award | [Link](#) 2024

– Award recognizing one undergraduate/graduate student/postdoc recognizing contributions to DEI.

Research Featured in National & International News | [BBC](#), [UMASS](#), [CoE](#), [ScienceDaily](#), [TechXplore](#) 2024

Young Researcher at 10th Heidelberg Laureate Forum | 11% acceptance rate | [Link](#) 2023

– A prestigious forum inviting 200 exceptional young researchers in mathematics and CS worldwide.

Best Ph.D. Forum Presentation Award at ACM SenSys 2022

Computing Research Association Education (CRA-E) Graduate Fellow | Two-year term | [Link](#) 2022

– National committee offers a graduate student role advocating undergraduate research.

Three Minute Thesis (3MT) finalist at UMASS | [Talk Link](#) 2022

Publications

My work has been published at the top venues in virtual, augmented, and mixed reality (VR/AR/MR), robotics, systems, and machine learning, including IEEE VR, TVCG, IROS, NeurIPS, ACM FAccT, and BuildSys/e-Energy.

[1] Yasra Chandio, Victoria Interrante, and Fatima Anwar: [Reaction Time as a Proxy for Presence in Mixed Reality with Distraction](#), IEEE Conference on Virtual Reality and 3D User Interfaces (VR), 2025. [Honorable Mention Best Paper Award, Top 3% paper] ^[1]

[2] Yasra Chandio, Victoria Interrante, and Fatima Anwar: [Tap into Reality: Understanding the Impact of Interactions on Presence and Reaction Time in Mixed Reality](#), IEEE Conference on Virtual Reality and 3D User Interfaces (VR), 2025. ^[1]

[3] Abdullah Al Ishtiaq*, Raja Hasnain Anwar*, Yasra Chandio, Fatima M. Anwar, Syed Rafiul Hussain, and Muhammad Taqi Raza: [Cloud Nine Connectivity: Evading in-Flight Paywalls For Free Internet](#), ACM Conference on Security and Privacy in Wireless and Mobile Networks (ACM WiSec), 2025.

[4] Momin Ahmad Khan, Yasra Chandio, Eugene Bagdasarian, and Fatima Anwar: [Poster: Compromising Federated Medical AI-Backdoor Risks in Prompt Learning](#), ACM Conference on Embedded Networked Sensor Systems (SenSys), 2025.

¹Due to substantial contribution selected to appear in TVCG Special Issue.

- [5] **Yasra Chandio**, Momin Ahmad Khan, Khotso Selialia, Luis Antonio Garcia, Joseph DeGol, and Fatima Anwar: *A Neurosymbolic Approach To Adaptive Feature Extraction In SLAM*, IEEE/RSJ International Conference on Intelligent Robots and Systems (IROS), 2024. **[5-minute Video Teaser]**
- [6] **Yasra Chandio**, Victoria Interrante, and Fatima Anwar: *Human Factors At Play: Understanding The Impact Of Conditioning On Presence And Reaction Time In Mixed Reality*, IEEE Conference on Virtual Reality and 3D User Interfaces (VR), 2024. **[¹] [Top 12% paper]**
- [7] **Yasra Chandio**, Noman Bashir, and Fatima Anwar: *Stealthy and practical multi-modal attacks on mixed reality tracking*, IEEE International Conference on Artificial Intelligence & extended and Virtual Reality (AIxVR), 2024. **[Best Paper Finalist]**
- [8] Momin Ahmad Khan, **Yasra Chandio**, and Fatima Anwar: *HYDRA-FL: Hybrid Knowledge Distillation for Robust and Accurate Federated Learning*, Annual Conference on Neural Information Processing Systems (NeurIPS), 2024.
- [9] Khotso Selialia, **Yasra Chandio**, and Fatima Anwar: *Mitigating feature heterogeneity biases in Federated Learning*, ACM Conference on Fairness, Accountability, and Transparency (FAccT), 2024.
- [10] **Yasra Chandio**, Noman Bashir, Tian Guo, Elsa Olivetti, and Fatima M. Anwar: *Scoping The Decarbonization Of Collaborative Mixed Reality*, IEEE International Symposium on Emerging Metaverse (ISEMV), 2024.
- [11] **Yasra Chandio**, Victoria Interrante, and Fatima Anwar: *Balancing Presence And Safety Using Reaction Time In Mixed Reality*, Workshop at IEEE International Symposium on Mixed and Augmented Reality (SafeAR@ISMAR), 2024.
- [12] **Yasra Chandio**, Noman Bashir, Victoria Interrante, and Fatima Anwar: *Investigating the Correlation Between Presence and Reaction Time in Mixed Reality*, IEEE Transactions on Visualization and Computer Graphics (TVCG), 2023.
- [13] Noman Bashir, **Yasra Chandio**, David Irwin, Fatima Anwar, Jeremy Gummeson, and Prashant Shenoy: *Jointly managing electrical and thermal energy in solar- and battery-powered computer systems*, ACM International Conference on Future Energy Systems (e-Energy), 2023.
- [14] **Yasra Chandio**, Noman Bashir, and Fatima Anwar: *Dataset: HoloSet - A dataset for visual inertial pose tracking in extended reality*, 5th International SenSys/BuildSys Workshop on Data (DATA), 2022.
- [15] **Yasra Chandio**: *Towards secure and immersive mixed reality: PhD Forum Abstract*, 20th ACM Conference on Embedded Networked Sensor Systems (SenSys), 2022. **[Best Presentation Award]**
- [16] Khotso Selialia, **Yasra Chandio**, and Fatima Anwar: *Federated Learning Biases in Heterogeneous Edge-Devices - A Case-Study*, 4th International SenSys/BuildSys Workshop on Challenges in Artificial Intelligence and Machine Learning for Internet of Things (AIChallengeloT), 2022.
- [17] **Yasra Chandio** and Fatima Anwar: *Poster: Spatiotemporal Security in Mixed Reality systems*, 18th ACM Conference on Embedded Networked Sensor Systems (SenSys), 2020.
- [18] **Yasra Chandio**, Aditya Mishra, and Anand Seetharam: *GridPeaks: Employing Distributed Energy Storage For Grid peak Reduction*, IEEE International Green and Sustainable Computing conference (IGSC), 2019.
- [19] **Yasra Chandio**, Jo A gila Bitsch, Affan A. Syed, and Muhammad Hamad Alizai: *Networking Wireless Energy in Embedded Networks*, ACM Transactions on Sensor Networks (TOSN), 2018.
- [20] Samar Abbas, Abu Bakar, **Yasra Chandio**, Khadija Hafeez, Ayesha Ali, Tariq M Jadoon, and Muhammad Hamad Alizai: *Inverted HVAC: Greenifying Older Buildings, One Room at a Time*, ACM Transactions on Sensor Networks (TOSN), 2018.
- [21] Khadija Hafeez, **Yasra Chandio**, Abu Bakar, Ayesha Ali, Affan A. Syed, Tariq M. Jadoon, and Muhammad Hamad Alizai: *Inverting HVAC for Energy Efficient Thermal Comfort in Populous Emerging Countries*, ACM International Conference on Systems for Energy-Efficient Built Environments (BuildSys), 2017. **[Audience Choice Award]**

- [22] M. Hamad Alizai, Qasim Raza, **Yasra Chandio**, Affan A. Syed, and Tariq M. Jadoon: [Simulating Intermittently Powered Embedded Networks](#), 13th International Conference on Embedded Wireless Systems and Networks (EWSN), 2016.

UNDER-REVIEW/IN-PREPARATION

- [1] **Yasra Chandio**, Khotso Selialia, Luis Antonio Garcia, Joseph DeGol, and Fatima M. Anwar: *Lost in Tracking Translation: A Comprehensive Analysis of Visual SLAM in Human-Centered XR and IoT Ecosystems*. [\[Preprint\]](#) [\[AIModels.fyi feature link\]](#)
- [2] **Yasra Chandio***, Diana Romero*, Salma Elmalaki, and Fatima M. Anwar: *What Sensors See, What People Feel: Exploring Subjective Collaboration Perception in Mixed Reality*. [\[* equal contribution\]](#) [\[Preprint\]](#)
- [3] Diana Romero*, **Yasra Chandio***, Fatima Anwar, and Salma Elmalaki: *GroupBeaMR: Analyzing Collaborative Group Behavior in Mixed Reality Through Passive Sensing and Sociometry*. [\[* equal contribution\]](#) [\[Preprint\]](#)
- [4] Khotso Selialia, **Yasra Chandio**, Jimi Oke, and Fatima Anwar: *LipFed: Mitigating Subgroup Bias in Federated Learning with Lipschitz Constraints*. [\[Preprint\]](#)
- [5] Khotso Selialia, **Yasra Chandio**, Jimi Oke, and Fatima Anwar: *ADAPT-FED: Adaptive Federated Optimization with Learning Stability*. [\[Preprint\]](#)
- [6] Momin Ahmad Khan, Virat Shejwalkar, **Yasra Chandio**, Amir Houmansadr, and Fatima M. Anwar: *Decoding FL Defenses: Systemization, Pitfalls, and Remedies*. [\[Preprint\]](#)
- [7] **Yasra Chandio**, Luis Antonio Garcia, Joseph DeGol, and Fatima M. Anwar: *ContinuumTrack: Adaptive Real-Time Profiling and Correction in Dynamic SLAM Systems*. [\[in preparation\]](#)
- [8] John Murray, **Yasra Chandio**, Fatima Anwar, and Michael Zink: *Exploring Relationship Between Quality Of Experience And Quality Of Service In Collaborative Mixed Reality*. [\[in preparation\]](#)
- [9] Momin Ahmad Khan, **Yasra Chandio**, and Fatima M. Anwar: *BAFFLe: Backdoor Attacks to Foundation Models in Federated Learning*. [\[in preparation\]](#)

Awards and Honors

Nokia Bell Labs Gift for Society for Women Researchers \$2000	2024
UMASS Campus Climate Improvement Grant \$2500	2024
Scholar at CRA-WP Grad Cohort Workshop for IDEALS	2024
IEEE Robotics and Automation Society (RAS) travel grant to attend IROS	2024
IEEE VR DEIA Award to attend IEEE VR	2024
Abbe Grant to attend HLF Highly selective grant, given to 30/200 HLF attendees	2023
CPS-IoT Week SIGBED student travel award declined	2023
Scholar at CRA-WP Grad Cohort	2022
Invited to attend Google PhD Fellowship Summit	2021
Honorable mention in UMASS ECE 3MT	2021
Selected for Computer Research Mentorship (CSRMP) Program at Google	2021
Grace Hopper Scholar to attend Grace Hopper Celebration	2019
National Science Foundation travel grant to attend IEEE IGSC	2019
Summer Provost Fellowship at Binghamton University	2019
Best Paper Audience Choice Award at ACM BuildSys	2017
ACM SenSys Travel grant to attend ACM BuildSys/SenSys	2017

Open Source Research Artifact

HoloSet - A Dataset for Visual-Inertial Pose Estimation in Extended Reality | [Link](#)

Media Coverage

Can AR and VR finally disrupt the exhausting culture of video meetings?	BBC
ECE's Yasra Chandio Qualifies as a "Rising Star" in Both Actual and Virtual Reality	CoE
College of Engineering Selects LaChance and Chandio for Its Diversity, Equity, and Inclusion Award	CoE
CRA Education Committee Selects New Graduate Fellow	CRA
New Study: Immersive Engagement In Mixed Reality Can Be Measured With Reaction Time	UMASS
Immersive Engagement in Mixed Reality Can Be Measured with Reaction Time	ScienceDaily
Study: Immersive Engagement in Mixed Reality Can Be Measured with Reaction Time	TechXplore

Teaching and Mentorship

Teaching Assistant

ECE 231: Introduction to Embedded System – helped design new labs	Spring 21–25
ECE 524/624: Advanced Embedded Systems (Graduate) – helped design course projects	Fall 21–23
ECE 322: Systems Programming	Fall 24
ECE 571 (SUNY): Programming Languages (Graduate)	Fall 19
CS 677 (LUMS): Internet of Things	Fall 16

Instructor

Taught Mixed Reality, Programming and helped design Capstone Projects (UMASS Turing Program)	2022–2025
Embedded System Programming (UMASS 3-week K-12 Engineering Outreach Summer Program)	2021

Guest Lecturer

Mixed Reality Beyond Pokemon Go (Pioneer Valley Chinese Immersion Charter School)	2024
Neurosymbolic Human Pose Tracking (CS+Robotics Club at Nashua High School, New Hampshire)	2024
Deep Learning based Tracking for Mobile Systems (UMASS ECE 524/624)	2023
Mixed Reality Security and Privacy (UMASS ECE 524/624)	2022
Introduction to Embedded System with <i>BeagleBone Black</i> (UMASS ECE 231)	2020

Mentorship

John Murray (UMASS PhD)	2024–
Diana Romero (UC Irvine PhD)	2023–
Standly Laguerre NSF REU (Macalester College)	2023
Kenneth Lin, Yav Rohatgi (UMASS BS) Project: Remote Interactions in MR	2023
Colin Leydon, Eyado Ocho (UMASS BS) Project: DNN based Tracking in Mobile Systems	2023
John Dale, Dani Kasti (UMASS BS) Project: Measuring Multi-User Collaboration in MR	2022
Yifan Meng, Linghao Meng, Shaoyu Dai, Yanan Zhang (UMASS MS)	2022
Project: Pose Estimation for Micro Movements in MR	
Zachary Wannier, Alexander Dickopf, Zhehang Zhang (UMASS MS)	2021
Project: Deep Learning Based Sensor Fusion for MR	
Subhankar Chowdhury, Abhinaba Das (UMASS MS) Sensor Fusion for IoT	2021
Xiaohao Xia, Yinxuan Wu, Xintao Ding, Xin Zhao (UMASS MS)	2021
Project: Remote collaboration in VR	
Nikhil Sarecha, Rehmat Singh (UMASS MS) Remote collaboration in MR with IoT device	2020

Service

Leadership

Chair , College of Engineering Dean's Graduate Advisory Group	2024–2025
Co-organizer , UMASS CoE GradLife Event Series Research Symposium	2024–2025
Organizer , UMASS ECE Women Dinner Series UMASS Campus Climate Grant (\$2500) [Link] – <i>Community building through a series of dinners with workshops and panels.</i>	2024–2025
Founding Chair , ECE Grad Gender Diversity group	2023–2025
Inaugural Graduate Student Inductee in ECE DEI Committee	2023–2025
Organizer , ECE Grad Women Retreats Raised \$2500	2023–2025
Organizer and Panelist , ECE Graduate Orientation	2023–2025
Editor , CRA-Undergraduate Research Highlights [Link] – <i>The series features outstanding undergraduate research across North America, offering insights into research experiences, mentorship, career advice, and promoting graduate education.</i>	2022–2024

Service to the Profession

Technical Program Committee Chair at Sensors S&P@CPSIoT-Week	2025
Publications Chair at SmartSP	2025
Associate Chair (AC) at ACM IMX	2025
Technical Program Committee member at ACM VRST , ACM Sensys Posters	2025
Reviewer at ICLR , IEEE VR , ACM CHI , IEEE ICRA , IMWUT , ACM MM	2025
Technical Program Committee member at DATA@Buildsys , ACM S3@Mobicom	2024
Reviewer at Journal of Parallel and Distributed Computing (JPDC)	2024
Shadow Program Committee member at ACM SenSys	2022
Shadow Program Committee member at ACM EuroSys	2022
Review Committee member at Extended Reality track at Grace Hopper Celebration (GHC)	2022
Student Volunteer at ACM SenSys	2022
Review Committee member at VR/AR/MR track at GHC	2021

Panelist

Research Career and Graduate School (UMASS ECE) – <i>A panel discussion on academic careers and life at graduate school.</i>	2024
Surviving PhD (UMASS Graduate Women In STEM) – <i>A panel discussion connecting UMASS graduate and undergraduate students to discuss careers in STEM.</i>	2024
Organizer & Moderator , Life at UMASS as a CS Undergraduate Student (UMASS Turing Program)	2023
Organizer & Moderator , UMASS Women in Engineering Day – <i>A panel discussion connecting industry with high school students to discuss careers in engineering.</i>	2023
Pathways To Graduate Research (UMASS ECE)	2023

Service to the Community

Volunteer , Amherst Survival Center	2020
Volunteer , Binghamton University Commencement	2019

Employment

Graduate Research Assistant, UMASS Amherst Advisor: <i>Fatima Anwar</i>	2020–on
Graduate Research Assistant, Binghamton University Advisor: <i>Gaunhua Yan</i>	2018–2019
Research Associate, LUMS, Pakistan Advisor: <i>Muhammad Hamad Alizai</i>	2015–2017
Research Engineer, NUCES, Pakistan Advisor: <i>Affan A. Syed</i>	2014–2015

References

1. Fatima Anwar , Assistant Professor at University of Massachusetts Amherst	fanwar@umass.edu
2. Victoria Interrante , Professor at University of Minnesota, Twin Cities	interran@umn.edu
3. Michael Zink , Professor at University of Massachusetts Amherst	mzink@umass.edu
4. Luis Antonio Garcia , Assistant Professor at University of Utah	la.garcia@utah.edu
5. Joseph DeGol , CTO at Steg AI	jomnipotent17@gmail.com